

Rich internet applications, or RIAs, in simpler terms are web applications that work like full-fledged desktop applications in many ways. They're delivered to the user through a site-specific browser either through a plug-in or a virtual machine. With more and more services moving to the cloud and with increased internet connectivity RIA development is in high demand. RIAs provide robust ways of interacting with users with way more efficiency than ever before. As a simple example, traditional applications generally tend to be limited to form fields, radio buttons, and check boxes whereas RIAs can allow the user to perform in-line editing, drag and drop items or otherwise interact directly with the elements. Popular browser-based RIAs include Flickr, Google Maps and eBay; desktop-based RIAs include Twhirl and Tweetdeck, both of which interact with the Twitter website; and enterprise applications such as Accelerate4Pharma, a pharmaceutical application.

A career in RIA development is becoming increasingly relevant and sought after. With the increasing penetration of the social web among the masses, RIAs dominate the arenas of online gaming as well as applications such as video, sharing and recording. Development of new technologies and web standards such as HTML5 and JavaScript-based widgets are set to provide solutions for mobile web experiences and fuel the need for new creative developers adept with RIA knowledge. As a developer familiar with RIA technologies, you can be assured of a career with top class placement in the programming and IT industry. With the increasing dependency on building

and developing content for browsers, desktops and mobile platforms, this sort of talent is being sought after in great demand by all modern IT and web companies.

Frameworks to build RIAs

A framework is the platform on which a RIA is built and deployed. There are many different RIA frameworks. One of the biggest such platforms for RIA development is offered by Adobe which includes Adobe Flash, Flex and AIR. Another such framework is Silverlight offered by Microsoft.